

Chapter 42 - Novel

At nine-thirty in the evening, there were fewer people in the hospital, and only Yan Lin's family of three was in this corridor. So only Father Yan saw Yan Lin get slapped by her mother.

Mother Yan usually had a good temper and rarely got angry in front of family members. But Father Yan, who had been married to her for over twenty years, knew that his wife's temperament wasn't naturally this mild and gentle.

Seeing Yan Lin get slapped, Father Yan knew Mother Yan was extremely angry, so he quickly reached out to hold her and comfort her: "Alright, alright, Shuyu, don't get angry. It's not good to make yourself sick from anger."

"How can I have time to worry about whether I'll get sick from anger? Look at what your precious daughter has done!" Mother Yan was furious, pointing straight at Yan Lin's nose as she scolded.

"Did you treat everything your father and I said to you before like we were talking nonsense? Look at what you did today!" Mother Yan glared at her daughter who remained silent in front of her. "If something really happens to Xiao Yue, you'll regret it!"

After saying this, Mother Yan pushed away Father Yan's hand and walked straight into the hospital room.

Father Yan watched Mother Yan's departing figure, closed his eyes and sighed, then said: "You're already in your twenties. I don't want to lecture you too much. But you definitely need to take responsibility for what you did today."

Yan Lin raised her head, looking at Father Yan with lifeless eyes.

"The doctor you asked me to help you contact has been reached. You're going abroad tomorrow. There happens to be some business for you to handle there, and after you finish handling it, the timing will be just right to meet that professor."

"I don't—"

Yan Lin was about to refuse when she saw her father's expression that brooked no refusal, and consciously kept quiet.

"I know what you want to do, but after everything you did today, Xiao Yue probably doesn't want to hear your apology."

Yan Lin lowered her head again. Her father was right. Even if she really wanted to apologize to Ah Yue, the other party probably didn't want to see her.

What she did to Feng Yue tonight was truly despicable.

She also knew that the rift that already existed between her and Feng Yue would widen again because of tonight's incident.

However, while Feng Yue didn't need Yan Lin's apology, Yan Lin still needed to apologize to Feng Yue's parents.

Feng Yue's parents didn't know what had happened between the two of them, but looking at the final result, Feng Yue had fainted from extreme anger and Yan Lin came to sincerely apologize with a somewhat swollen face.

No matter how much dissatisfaction and anger the two elders had, in the end it could only be reduced to a single "forget it."

They wouldn't forgive Yan Lin on Feng Yue's behalf, nor would they presume to hate her.

This was a matter between the two children, and it wasn't their place to interfere. But just as Yan Lin was about to leave, Father Feng, who couldn't swallow this grievance, still called out to stop her.

"Ah Lin."

Yan Lin respectfully responded: "Uncle."

"Your aunt and I don't know what exactly happened between you and Nuan Nuan¹, but I want to tell you, if you still have even the slightest bit of feelings for Nuan Nuan, then I hope you can put her condition first.

I don't want tonight's incident to happen again, and I certainly don't want to one day see white-haired people send off black-haired people². Uncle is just an ordinary father, but even if I'm ordinary and incompetent, I will resort to any means when my child is threatened."

Yan Lin could clearly sense the threat in Father Feng's words. She also knew this was a warning that the other party, as Feng Yue's father, was issuing to her.

As elders, they shouldn't interfere in emotional matters between children, but this matter had already threatened Feng Yue's life safety, so as elders they had to intervene a bit more.

Yan Lin lowered her eyes and bowed slightly to Father Feng, saying sincerely and earnestly: "Uncle, I understand. I'm very sorry about today's incident."

Father Feng looked at her for a while, then waved his hand to signal her to leave.

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Feng Yue's head was dizzy. She only remembered slapping Yan Lin before losing consciousness; she couldn't remember what happened after that.

Her brain was sending her signals of "fatigue," which made her let her consciousness sink into sleep.

Feng Yue felt like she had a dream. In the dream, she seemed to have returned to the time just after her death, arriving at that space filled with blue light. In the space, there was still that book floating in mid-air.

Feng Yue felt herself standing in place for a while, then lifted her feet to walk toward that book.

But just as Feng Yue looked down, she discovered that the cover that originally bore the four characters "An Lin's Past Events" had become a blank white expanse.

No words, no symbols whatsoever.

Feng Yue curiously reached out to open the book, but all the content inside had disappeared as well, becoming a blank white book without any words.

Feng Yue frowned tightly, completely unable to understand what had happened. Why had the book that was originally filled with stories of "Yan Lin" and "Chu An'an" become completely wordless? Why had she come here again to discover all this?

Feng Yue didn't understand, and time wouldn't let her slowly figure it out here.

Another wave of dizziness struck, and when Feng Yue regained consciousness, what she saw was a white ceiling.

"Nuan Nuan, you're awake. Do you feel uncomfortable anywhere?" Mother Feng was the first to notice that Feng Yue had awakened.

She and Father Feng had watched over her at the hospital all night. Father Feng had work at the company today, so Mother Feng had sent him home at dawn. Now only mother and daughter were in the room.

The results of Feng Yue's examinations were all fine. The reason she fainted was due to excessive emotional stimulation.

So after consulting with Professor Fang, Wei Yuran didn't give Feng Yue any medication, only hung an IV bag of glucose for her.

When Feng Yue woke up, she naturally had to undergo another medical examination, but this time it wasn't Wei Yuran who came to examine her, but Professor Fang who had been in charge of Feng Yue's condition all along.

After Professor Fang's examination and announcement that Feng Yue was fine and could go home, Feng Yue finally got some time alone with Mother Feng.

Feng Yue had only stayed in this hospital room for one night, so there wasn't much to take with her. The Feng family's driver was already waiting at the hospital entrance.

Feng Yue linked arms with her mother, walking quietly in the hospital corridor.

"Mom, don't you have anything to ask me?" Feng Yue asked.

Mother Feng sighed and patted Feng Yue's hand, shaking her head: "No."

Feng Yue pressed her lips together and nodded.

"But—" Mother Feng continued, "Mom doesn't want to receive news of you being hospitalized in the middle of the night again. Your father and I really can't handle it, Nuan Nuan."

Feng Yue lowered her head: "Mom, I'm sorry for making you worry."

"Nuan Nuan, this isn't something you need to apologize for. Your father and I don't understand what's going on between you and Ah Lin, and we won't interfere in matters between you two. But you need to know that your father and I will always put your life and safety above everything else."

"I understand."

Mother Feng smiled slightly, reaching out to arrange the hair by Feng Yue's cheek: "Let's go home for this year. Don't make us worry anymore."

Feng Yue's throat felt somewhat blocked and her nose tingled. She nodded and agreed to her mother's request: "Alright!"

Feng Yue's independent living came to an end. Because of the accident that night, she moved back home.

And she never heard or learned any news about Yan Lin again. The other party seemed to have disappeared from her life after that night.

This was undoubtedly a blessing for Feng Yue. Yan Lin's appearance would only cause fluctuations in her mood, thereby affecting her condition.

And she only hoped she could live a little longer. To accompany her parents a little longer.

The dream she had in the hospital also made her quite concerned. She clearly remembered that the first time she saw that book in the blue space, it told the story between "Yan Lin" and "Chu An'an."

The story began in the fourth year after her death, but this time when she looked again, there wasn't a single word on that book.

This was probably a matter concerning her own life, so Feng Yue asked Wen Zhen to help her pay attention to whether there was a star named "Chu An'an" in the entertainment industry or at film school.

The news that Wen Zhen eventually brought was neither good nor bad. There was no star named "Chu An'an" in the entertainment industry, but there was indeed one and only one student named "Chu An'an" at Beijing Film Academy.

She had just enrolled as a freshman in the Performance Department at Beijing Film Academy this September.

Feng Yue looked at the information Wen Zhen brought her. The information even included a passport photo of the girl—very beautiful. Just from the passport photo alone, you could tell this girl was very beautiful.

Feng Yue carefully read through Chu An'an's life history in the materials. The girl was born into a well-off family, with loving parents who had doted on her since childhood.

As a child, she liked ballet and was sent to interest classes by her mother. She studied for over ten years. Finally, this year she passed the arts examination and got admission to Beijing Film Academy. She was now just an ordinary, beautiful freshman at film school.

Her story with Yan Lin would begin in four years, which was exactly when Chu An'an would graduate from university.

Feng Yue quickly finished reading through this information and nodded with satisfaction.

Very good. Chu An'an was still attending school step by step. The timeline of the novel hadn't started yet.

This meant that the improvement in Feng Yue's condition hadn't yet been corrected by the novel's will. As long as she carefully followed medical advice and treated her illness properly, she might be able to cross over the approaching period of near-death.

She had already divorced Yan Lin now. Her existence wouldn't affect the subsequent emotional development of those two people, so she, "Feng Yue," was no longer someone who absolutely had to die.

Feng Yue locked this information in the drawer of her room, then went downstairs to eat at Mother Feng's call.

Although she still hadn't figured out why the book in the blue space had no words at all, she no longer cared.

As long as she could cross over her death date and survive, then regardless of whether Yan Lin ended up with "Chu An'an" or "Chu Jingjing"³ later, it would have nothing to do with her.

She just wanted to live well and properly accompany her family and friends.

Footnotes:

¹ 囡囡 (Nuan Nuan) - An affectionate nickname meaning "little girl" or "baby girl," commonly used by parents in some Chinese dialects.

² 白发人送黑发人 (bái fà rén sòng hēi fà rén) - A Chinese idiom meaning "white-haired people send off black-haired people," referring to the tragedy of parents outliving their children.

³ 楚静静 (Chu Jingjing) - Feng Yue is making a play on words here, suggesting that it doesn't matter what the other woman's name is, as it's no longer her concern.